

ABDULLA ALIKANOO I

SYSTEMS ENGINEER · INFRASTRUCTURE & IT OPERATIONS

Dubai, United Arab Emirates · +971 54 791 0267 · +971 50 477 8701 · alikanoo@yahoo.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Systems Engineer with **16+ years** of IT infrastructure, systems administration, and enterprise support experience across UAE construction and conglomerate environments. Proven record operating multi-site networks, Windows Server / Hyper-V / Nutanix platforms, FortiGate firewalls, Microsoft 365 and Exchange, Veeam backup, and IT service management for **500+ users**. Microsoft Certified (MCSE, Azure Fundamentals) and ITIL 4 Foundation certified, with a practical focus on availability, security, and timely service delivery.

CORE SKILLS

Infrastructure	Windows Server 2016 / 2012 / 2008 R2 · Hyper-V clustering · Nutanix HCI · HPE BladeSystem C7000 · NAS storage
Network & Security	FortiGate 100F / 60F / 40F · FortiClient VPN · Mimecast · Bitdefender · Heimdal · endpoint patching
Cloud & Identity	Microsoft 365 admin · Azure AD · Active Directory · Exchange · PowerShell · mailbox lifecycle
Telephony	Avaya IP Office Manager · IP Office 500 V2 · Avaya Contact Center Select · Cisco IP Phone
Operations	Veeam Backup (disk & tape) · PaperCut MPS · BMC · ManageEngine · ITIL 4 · IT asset management
Business systems	SAP · Microsoft Dynamics 365 · Xpedeon · Orbits ERP · CAFM · FSA · biometric access & IP CCTV

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Systems Engineer

January 2024 – Present

Al Sahel Contracting Co. LLC · Dubai, UAE

- Manage and monitor enterprise network and server infrastructure across head office and remote sites, keeping systems patched, available, and current.
- Administer physical and virtual server backups (disk and tape) with Veeam Backup to protect production workloads.
- Maintain FortiGate firewalls for head office and all sites; operate and monitor Avaya PABX telephony.
- Triage and close daily IT service requests by priority; monitor site file servers and attendance systems.
- Provision and configure new endpoints, keep end-user operating systems current, and register IT assets in ERP with proper tagging.
- Administer Microsoft Exchange (mailbox creation, performance monitoring) and email security via Mimecast; manage endpoint security with Bitdefender and Heimdal.
- Deploy and support multifunction printers using PaperCut Managed Print Services.

IT Support Engineer — Corporate Team

September 2017 – January 2024

Al Ghurair Group · Dubai, UAE

- Delivered IT end-user and application support for **500+ users** across group business units, corporate offices, and site locations in Dubai and the Northern Emirates.
- Operated data-center services for servers and branch/site connectivity; supported an HPE BladeSystem C7000 enclosure with 10 blade servers in a clustered Hyper-V environment.
- Supported Nutanix hyperconverged infrastructure and NAS storage; installed and configured FortiClient VPN and provisioned user access.
- Resolved helpdesk tickets to SLA using BMC and ManageEngine; maintained IT asset records in ManageEngine.
- Administered Avaya IP Office and Avaya Contact Center Select for corporate telephony and customer-care operations.
- Managed the Microsoft 365 admin portal and Azure AD; used PowerShell to standardize user and mailbox configuration.
- Installed and configured FSA, CAFM, SAP, Xpedeon, and Orbits ERP; supported the Dynamics 365 implementation team.
- Implemented and supported biometric access control and IP CCTV surveillance.

IT Support Engineer

November 2006 – September 2017

ETA Star International · Dubai, UAE

- Installed, configured, and maintained computer equipment and peripherals at head office and site offices across Abu Dhabi, Hamriyah Free Zone (Sharjah), Ras Al Khaimah, and Dubai.
- Provided IT support to ESI divisions and engineering verticals, including domain join, Outlook/email setup, and Active Directory user lifecycle (create, reset, and disable accounts per HR policy).
- Monitored antivirus, internet, and Outlook services; assembled, installed, and maintained hardware and software, including network/local printers, scanners, and ADSL routers.
- Maintained master records of domain, internet, email, and SAP users; installed SAP clients and coordinated employee-exit IT NOCs.
- Configured Cisco IP phones and mobile devices (BlackBerry, iPhone); coordinated with Etisalat and du for provisioning, termination, and billing so Accounts received accurate monthly and half-yearly statements.
- Maintained the organizational IT asset database and asset-management records.

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer (MCSE)

Microsoft

ITIL 4 Foundation

AXELOS / PeopleCert

Microsoft Azure Fundamentals

Microsoft Certification ID: 11406262

EDUCATION

Master of Computer Applications (M.C.A.)

Anna University, Chennai, India

2002 – 2005

B.Sc. Computer Science

M.S. University, Tirunelveli, India

1999 – 2002

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

LANGUAGES

English · Hindi · Tamil · Malayalam

UAE DRIVING LICENSE

Dubai · 1371884 · Expires 19 Jan 2029

PERSONAL

19 July 1982 · Dubai, UAE